Pacific Ridge School Curricular Progressions 2025-2026

Graduation Requirements

Pacific Ridge School students are expected to carry a minimum of five core academic courses during each school term. The requirement for the Pacific Ridge School diploma is the equivalent of twenty two full-year courses, eighteen of which are required courses or courses elected from designated departmental offerings; the other four may be chosen from any area and may be earned through any combination of full-year and trimester-long courses. Teacher recommendations are the primary determinant for enrollment in honors and AP classes. Juniors may take up to three AP courses; seniors may take up to four.

SUBJECT	GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS	SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS
English	4 years	English is required every year
History & Social Sciences	3 years	1 year of World History and 1 year of US History required
Science	3 years	Science 9 and Science 10 required
Mathematics	3 years	Algebra/Geometry 3 required
Visual or Performing Arts	2 years	The Arts requirement should be completed by the end of 10th grade
World Language	3 years	Three years in a single language
PE / Health	2 years	5 trimesters of PE; 1 trimester of Health

Progression by Subject

English (4 years required)

9th Grade	10th Grade	11th Grade & 12th Grade
English 9	English 10	African American Literature American Literature Honors American Literature* Genre Studies Rhetoric and Composition Women in Literature World Literature AP Language and Composition* AP Literature*

History & Social Sciences (3 years required, including US History)

9th Grade	10th Grade	11th Grade & 12th Grade
Ancient World History	Modern World History	Asian American and Pacific Islander Studies Ethnic Studies Latin American History Theory of Knowledge US History AP US History* AP US Government and Politics*
	AP World History: Modern*	***Courses Rotated out for 25-26*** Contemporary Human Geography Economics Middle East History and Diplomacy Theories of Social Change

* indicates teacher recommendation is required

Progression by Subject

Science (3 years required)

9th Grade	10th Grade	11th Grade & 12th Grade
Science 9	Science 10	Anatomy and Physiology AP Biology* Biotechnology AP Chemistry* Engineering Design Honors Environmental Science* AP Environmental Science* Marine Biology Honors Physics* AP Physics C*
Honors Science 9*	**Honors Science 10***	

General Electives

9th Grade	10th Grade	11th Grade & 12th Grade
		AP Art History AP Psychology * Financial Literacy Journalism & Media Studies 1 & 2 Programming 1 & 2

* indicates teacher recommendation is required

Progression by Subject

Mathematics Progression (3 years required)

The 9th grade entry point for math is determined by teacher recommendation, student history, and/or a placement examination.

Algebra/Geometry Sequence

Algebra 1B

Algebra/ Geometry 1	Algebra/ Geometry 2	Algebra/ Geometry 3
Honors Algebra/ Geometry 1*	Honors Algebra/ Geometry 2*	Honors Algebra/ Geometry 3*

Advanced Mathematics Courses

Precalculus	Calculus
Honors Precalculus*	AP Calculus AB*
Statistics	AP Calculus BC*
AP Statistics*	Discrete Mathematics*
Data Science	Differential Equations*

World Language Progression (3 years required)

The 9th grade entry point for world language is determined by teacher recommendation, student history, and/or a placement examination. Levels 2 and higher have advanced/honors courses available.

Typical Core and Honors Track (Chinese, French, or Spanish)

Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5	
	Level 2 Advanced*	Level 3 Honors*	Level 4 Honors*	AP Level*	Level 5 Honors*

* Indicates teacher recommendation is required

Progression by Subject

Visual & Performing Arts Progressions (2 years required)

The first course listed in each strand is the introductory level. Progression within a strand is determined by teacher recommendation.

Digital Filmmaking 1	Digital Filmmaking 2		
Intro to Digital Photography	Adv Digital Photography	Honors Digital Photography	AP 2D Art/Design: Photo
Graphic Design 1	Graphic Design 2	Honors Graphic Design	AP 2D Art/Design: Graphics
Yearbook			
Intro to Visual Arts	2D Design, Ceramics, or 3D Design	Honors Visual Arts	AP Drawing
		AP Art History *	
Jazz Rock Ensemble	Honors Jazz Rock Ensemble		
Classical Music Ensemble	Honors Classical Music Ensemble		
Vocal Ensemble	Honors Vocal Ensemble		
Intro to Theater Arts	Advanced Theater Arts	Honors Theater Ensemble	
Dance 1/2	Dance 3/4	Honors Dance Ensemble	